

ScavengerTimeLimit, and In the Value data box, type 60. Click OK and close the Registry Editor.

A Sound Solution

Q I have a Creative SoundBlaster Live! installed on my Windows XP computer. Every time I try to shut down the computer, I get an error message that says, "DEVLDR not responding." When I click End Now, the computer stops responding.

Sarabjeet Singh

A This is most likely a corrupt driver. Go to Control Panel > System > Hardware tab > Device Manager. Expand Sound, Video and Game Controllers. Right-click on Creative Labs SoundBlaster, and select Uninstall. When you are prompted to confirm the deletion, click Yes. Then download and install the updated driver from the SoundBlaster Web site: www.soundblaster.com/support/winxp

Out, Junk!

Q I frequently get the low disk space notification on my C drive and so tried to run the Disk Cleanup utility, but it stops responding while searching for compressed files.

Veronica Gonzales

A This problem can be caused by a corrupt temporary directory. You need to clear this directory to get rid of the problem: close all applications. Run %temp% to open the Temp folder. Delete all the files there. Close Windows Explorer. Open the Control Panel and double-click the Internet Options applet. Select the General tab, and click Delete Files. Check Delete All Offline Content. Click OK.

Who's The Boss?

Q In Windows XP, I accidentally marked a partition on my hard drive as active, and am not able to boot ever since. I get this error message: NTLDR is missing

Press Ctrl+Alt+Del to restart
Please help.

Rajesh Pai

A The partition you've marked as active does not contain the Windows boot files. Try changing the active partition by booting via a floppy disk and then using disk utilities to manually change the active partition: boot to a command prompt using a Microsoft Windows 9x / ME boot floppy disk. At the prompt, type fdisk and press [Enter]. When you are prompted to enable large disk support, click



Yes. Click Set active partition, press the number of the partition that you want to make active, and then press [Enter]. Press [Esc]. Remove the boot floppy disk and restart the computer. If you don't have a floppy drive, use Parted Magic from our August DVD—it gives you a graphical interface to do the same thing.

Telling The Tale

Q I've often wondered that if Windows creates dump files when it crashes, shouldn't there be a way to read and interpret them?

Amit Chanana

A Memory dump file creation is a very useful diagnostic tool found in all Windows systems based on NT. A memory dump is an output file generated by the operating system during a crash and is very useful in determining the cause of the crash. This file is saved as a file with the DMP extension in the system32 directory. The option (if it is currently disabled) to create a dump file can be set up by opening Control Panel > System > Advanced tab > Settings button under Startup and Recovery. The dump file can be analysed using a tool from Microsoft known as dumpchk.exe, available for download from www.microsoft.com/whdc/devtools/debugging/default.mspx. There are different versions of this tool available for different versions of Windows; choose yours. Detailed information about using dumpchk.exe can be found at <http://support.microsoft.com/?kbid=156280>. To actually interpret the dump, though, you need to know Windows' ins and outs.

Reinstalling The Installer!

Q When I try to uninstall certain programs, I get the following error:

Error 1719. The Windows Installer Service could not be accessed. You may be running in safe mode or Windows Installer may not be correctly installed.

Manish Sen

A Your Windows Installer seems to be corrupt and reinstalling it should solve your problem. At a command prompt, type in the following line and then press [Enter] ("Drive" is the drive where Windows is installed; "%Windir%" is the folder where Windows is installed):

```
attrib -r -s -h drive:\%Windir%\system32\dlldata
```

For example, you might type in

```
attrib -r -s -h c:\windows\system32\dlldata
```

Then at the prompt, type in the following lines, pressing [Enter] after each line:

```
ren msi.dll msi.old
ren msiexec.exe msiexec.old
ren msihnd.dll msihnd.old
```

Exit the DOS prompt and restart your computer. Update the Windows Installer files on your hard disk to the latest version. Get it from the Microsoft Download Center at <http://support.microsoft.com/kb/893803/>. Shut down your computer, and then restart it in standard mode.■